Code Orange and The Good News

By Matt Mason

INTRODUCTION

Secretary of Defense, Donald Rumsfeld once said . . . . "There are known knowns. These are things we know that we know. There are known unknowns. That is to say, there are things that we know we don't know. But there are also unknown unknowns. There are things we don't know we don't know."

How do you conduct your life in this time of terror when every day is Code Orange by Mat Mason

Code Orange

It's not always

the little boy

who cries

Wolf!

sometimes

the wolf

cries

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wolf

and

points away.

Duct tape your doors shut,

we're on Code Orange, Code Orange, people,

blue skies

no matter, there's anthrax

somewhere, somebody said something about smallpox

wherever, an unnamed man reportedly said

something

big

was coming down

eventually. A man said

people were going to die,

people are going to die,

Americans are going to die.

Officials are quoted as saying things,

officials are quoted as saying, Hurry, hurry, run,

seal yourself in a ziplock bag

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in a lead-walled box
in a hole
in the earth
in prayer to our God,

and sources report
we aren't ready, we're not scared enough
and if we
don't get a little more hysterical,
then the terrorists will win

because sources suggest
it could be any day, hour, minute, second,
duck!
it could be any metropolis, city, small town, farmstead,
or possibly even somewhere else; for God's sake,
there are
experts
saying
we're not safe, we're not safe,
now do what we say

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and nobody gets hurt.

There's fear
out past your walls, there's fear itself
blowing against the plastic sheeting and the bars of grey
tape,
there's so much
to fear, we must do more,
we have to fight them,
kill them, cripple them
for Jesus,
Amen!

It's not always
the little boy
who cries
Wolf!
Sometimes the wolf
cries wolf.

And it's not always the wolf

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our little boys are sent out

to kill.

TRANSITION

So how DO you conduct your life in this time of terror? Who do you turn to for re-assurance? Who provides that peace for you? Perhaps, if you could find Jesus in everyday situations, and not get wrapped up in the seriousness of life, He could be the solace for you too. That's The Good News by Matt Mason.

The Good News

Jesus lent me ten bucks when I forgot my wallet at

lunch.

Sure, he could've ordered a chicken pesto sandwich

and broke it into two full meals, but he's no show off.

That's what I like about Jesus.

Jesus listens to cool music. If it weren't for Jesus,

I never would have known about Tom Waits

or Ani DiFranco, and I sure wouldn't own any Lyle

Lovett.

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But Jesus makes a kickass mix tape.

Jesus loves cows,

thinks my poems with cows in them are a hoot

and encourages me

to look at herds of white cows

in a green field

and imagine salvation

is underneath each windmill.

Jesus tells me Pat Robertson's right,

and so is Al Sharpton.

That they're both wrong, too,

but that's not the point.

His point's how God's sewn into every fabric.

Even yourself. Even Elvis.

Jesus saves and Jesus recycles.

Jesus eats fish for more

than Omega-3 fatty acids,

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drinks red wine for more reasons
than his sacred heart.

Jesus doesn't dress like the Medieval paintings
with the gold hats and the Mr. T rosaries.
Sure, he can clean up nice,
but Jesus likes blue jeans.

Jesus pisses me off
with his honesty
sometimes.
But it's not like he's ever wrong.

Jesus makes a killer chianti,
but he refuses to turn water
into Diet Coke for me.
"What's the difference?" he asks.

Jesus acts real serious
when somebody rushes up to him hollering, "Jesus,
can you take me up to Heaven,

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I will see you in the Kingdom, Jesus!"
Jesus says they should get their kumbayayas off
by putting on some overalls
and hammering in the morning.
May as well make Heaven bigger,
not just your egos.

Jesus digs the "How does Jesus eat M&M's" joke.
He won't do it at a party, but he did do it once
when just the two of us were watching cartoons.

Jesus wanted me to tell you he loves you.
Jesus also wants you to stop doing that thing.

Jesus tells me I'm saved.
Then he laughs real loud.
Jesus makes me nervous when he does that.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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